

[illegible]

1 Multiple choice questions

Choose the correct answer.

1. (2 points) Which of the following sorting algorithms has the best average-case time complexity?

- A. Bubble Sort
- B. Merge Sort
- C. Insertion Sort
- D. Selection Sort

1. _____

2. (2 points) Which sorting algorithm is not stable in its standard implementation?

- A. Merge Sort
- B. Bubble Sort
- C. Quick Sort
- D. Insertion Sort

2. _____

3. (2 points) Which sorting algorithm is not in-place in its standard implementation?

- A. Bubble Sort
- B. Quick Sort
- C. Heap Sort
- D. Merge Sort

3. _____

4. (2 points) What is the best-case running time of Insertion Sort?

- A. $O(n)$
- B. $O(n \log n)$
- C. $O(\log n)$
- D. $O(n^2)$

4. _____

5. (2 points) How many of the following algorithms use the divide-and-conquer strategy? Selection Sort, Insertion Sort, Bubble Sort, Merge Sort, Heap Sort, Quick Sort, Counting Sort, and Radix Sort.

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 4

5. _____

6. (2 points) In the worst case, how many comparisons does Quick Sort perform on an array of n elements?

- A. $O(n)$
- B. $O(n \log n)$
- C. $O(\log n)$
- D. $O(n^2)$

6. _____

7. (2 points) What input leads Quick Sort to its worst-case time complexity in the naive pivot choice (last element)?

- A. Random order array
- B. Already sorted array
- C. Reverse sorted array
- D. Both B and C

7. _____

8. (2 points) Consider the recurrence $T(n) = T(\frac{n}{2} + \sqrt{n}) + 75$. What is the asymptotic complexity?

- A. $\Theta(\log n)$
- B. $\Theta(n)$
- C. $\Theta(n \log n)$
- D. $\Theta(1)$

8. _____

9. (2 points) Consider the recurrence $T(n) = 2T(\frac{n}{2}) + n \log n$. What is the asymptotic complexity?

- A. $\Theta(n \log n)$
- B. $\Theta(n \log^2 n)$
- C. $\Theta(n^2)$
- D. $\Theta(n^2 \log n)$

9. _____

10. (2 points) Consider the recurrence $T(n) = T(\frac{n}{2}) + T(\frac{n}{3}) + n + 3\sqrt{n} + 5 \log n + 9$. What is the asymptotic complexity?

- A. $\Theta(n\sqrt{n} \log n)$
- B. $\Theta(n\sqrt{\log n})$
- C. $\Theta(n\sqrt{n})$
- D. $\Theta(n)$

10. _____

11. (2 points) Counting Sort works best when:

- A. Input is large, but k is very large compared to n
- B. Input is large, and $k = O(n)$
- C. Input is small, but k is very large
- D. Input is floating-point numbers in arbitrary range

11. _____

12. (2 points) In a max-heap with height 5, the third largest element can only be located among how many nodes?

- A. 2
- B. 4
- C. 6
- D. 8

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12. _____

13. (2 points) What is the time complexity of extract-max in a max-heap with n elements?

- A. $O(1)$
- B. $O(\log n)$
- C. $O(n)$
- D. $O(n \log n)$

13. _____

14. (2 points) Suppose we apply the bucket sort algorithm with n buckets to sort n numbers that are drawn uniformly at random from the interval $[0, 1)$. On expectation, how many buckets will remain empty?

- A. n/e
- B. $n/2$
- C. $\sqrt{n}$
- D. 0

14. _____

15. (2 points) You want to maintain the running median of a sequence as new numbers are inserted dynamically. A common approach uses two heaps: a max-heap to store the smaller half of the elements and a min-heap to store the larger half. What is the worst-case time complexity for inserting a new element and performing any necessary rebalancing?

- A. $O(1)$
- B. $O(\log n)$
- C. $O(\log^2 n)$
- D. $O(n)$

15. _____

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2 Short Answer Questions

Please provide your responses in the spaces provided. Only fully complete answers will be eligible to receive full marks.

16. (3 points) When building a heap from an existing array of n elements, should we use the top-down method or the bottom-up method? Justify your answer in terms of time complexity.

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17. (3 points) The k -th order statistic of an array of n elements can be found in different ways. Analyze the running time for each of the following three approaches:

- Sorting the array and then picking the k -th element.
- Building a min-heap and extracting elements until the k -th is reached.
- Using the deterministic Select (Median-of-Medians) algorithm.

State the time complexity for each method in terms of n and k , and briefly justify your answers.

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18. (3 points) An inversion in an array $A[1 \dots n]$ is a pair of indices (i, j) such that $i < j$ and $A[i] > A[j]$. For an array of size 10, what is the maximum number of possible inversions?

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19. (3 points) Explain how the number of inversions affects the running time of Insertion Sort.

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20. (3 points) Let $f(n)$ be an asymptotically non-negative function satisfying the following conditions:

- $f(n) = o(a^n)$ for every constant $a > 1$, and
- $f(n) = \omega(n^k)$ for any positive integer k .

Provide an example of such a function $f(n)$.

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21. (3 points) Decide whether the statement $f(2n) = O(f(n))$ holds for every asymptotically nonnegative function $f(n)$. Either prove the statement (give a correct proof for all such f), or disprove it by giving a counterexample.

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22. (3 points) Solve the recurrence $T(n) = 3T(\frac{n}{2}) + n^2$.

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23. (3 points) You are given two linked lists A and B , each containing a subset of integers from 1 to n . You are asked to design an $O(|A| + |B|)$ algorithm to return a new linked list that represents the intersection $A \cap B$. How would you approach this problem?

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24. (3 points) Aziz and Dilshod are playing a game with a given array A of integers. Aziz secretly picks two indices i and j ($i \leq j$) and asks Dilshod to quickly tell him the sum of all elements of the input array A between positions i and j , that is, $\sum_{i}^j A[i]$. Dilshod is allowed to preprocess the array in-place before the game starts. What preprocessing technique should Dilshod use so that each query is answered in $O(1)$ time?

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25. (3 points) You are given an input array of size $n - 1$, where each element is a distinct integer between 1 and n . Hence, exactly one number in that range is missing from the array. Explain an in-place algorithm that runs in $O(n)$ time to find the missing number.

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3 Algorithm Design Questions

Please provide your responses under the problem statements. To receive full marks, you need to provide proof of correctness and running-time analysis of your algorithms.

26. (20 points) Sevinch is analyzing the daily stock prices of a company, stored in an array $A[0 \dots n]$, where each element represents the stock price on a given day. He wants to find the best days i and $j (j > i)$ to buy and then sell the stock, so that the profit $A[j] - A[i]$ is maximized. Design an algorithm that finds such indices in $O(n \log n)$ time.

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27. (20 points) The Intergalactic Science Council is selecting a team of 3 astronauts for a prestigious competition. There are n candidates, each with an integer skill score stored in the array A . To form a perfectly balanced team, the sum of the three selected candidates' skill scores must equal a given target S . Given A and S , your task is to determine whether there exists a subset of exactly three candidates whose sum equals S . Your algorithm should run in $O(n^2 \log n)$ time.